PRODUCT & TECHNICAL PROPOSAL

Project: Church Communications Agent
Prepared For: Lorenzo
Prepared By: Parag & Development Team
Target Delivery: Q1 Launch (January)

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1. Executive Summary & Strategic Positioning

A. The Core Mission

Parish priests and clergy spend **at least 2 to 4+ hours every single week** wrestling with document formatting, hunting down lectionary readings, resizing musical scores, and compiling parish announcements. Lorenzo aptly identifies this administrative burden as the *"unholy work of being a priest."*

The **Church Communications Agent** is an AI-powered assistant designed specifically for faith communities. Rather than attempting to automate pastoral theology or sermon writing—domains where congregations and clergy are naturally cautious or skeptical—this platform automates repetitive, administrative busywork. By removing this burden, the agent restores clergy time for the *"holy work"*: hospital visits, pastoral counseling, preaching, and personal ministry.

B. Strategic Naming: "Communications Agent" vs. "Bulletin Maker"

Per Lorenzo's direction, the system is purposefully branded and positioned as a **Communications Agent** rather than merely a "bulletin builder." While the Sunday bulletin serves as the high-utility wedge for initial adoption, this positioning ensures parishes do not pigeonhole the product as a single-purpose utility. It establishes a natural runway to expand into newsletters, social media video repurposing, and press releases.

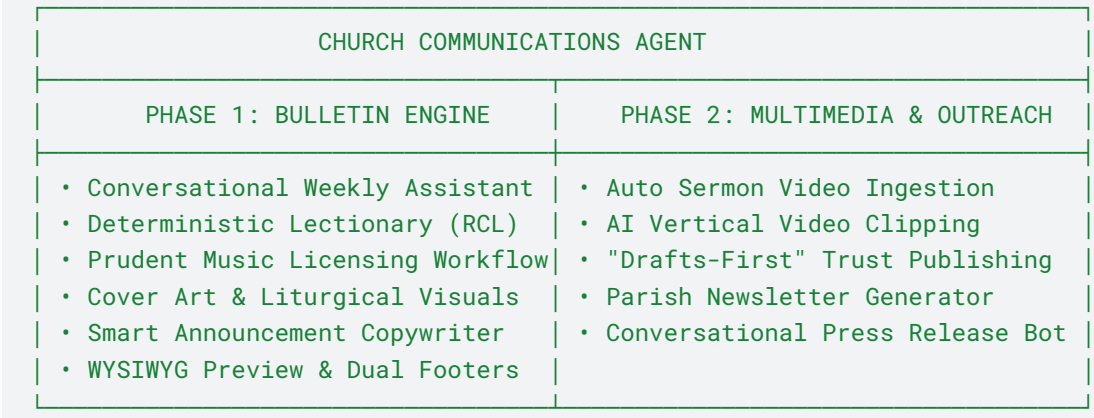
C. The "Trojan Horse" for Church AI Adoption

Clergy who are hesitant about artificial intelligence will be comfortable adopting an agent that performs purely formulaic administrative compilation. By delivering dependable weekly time savings with complete human oversight, the tool builds institutional trust in AI.

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2. High-Level Scoping

None



Phase 1: The Weekly Sunday Bulletin Engine

Phase 1 automates the weekly print production cycle, focusing on the core variables that change every Sunday: **readings, cover art, music, and announcements**.

1. Conversational Workflow Engine

- **Form Factor:** Clean, distraction-free web application chat widget (with optional email/notification reminders).
- **Deterministic State Machine:** A 4-step weekly conversational guide:
    1. *Liturgical Calendar & Season Selection*
    2. *Cover Artwork Selection*
    3. *Music & Hymn Identification*
    4. *Parish Announcement Ingestion*

2. Liturgical Calendar & Lectionary Database (RCL)

- **Local Deterministic Database:** Embeds the complete **Revised Common Lectionary (RCL)** across the 3-year cycle (**Year A, Year B, Year C**), eliminating reliance on fragile external APIs.
- **Ordinary Time Mechanics:** Accurately models the theological fork in "The Green Season":
    - **Track 1 vs. Track 2 Logic:** Accounts for the liturgical rule where the **Epistle and Gospel are identical** across both tracks, while the **Old Testament lesson and Psalm diverge** (Track 1 = continuous narrative; Track 2 = thematic pairing).

- **Feast Days vs. Sunday Propers:** Programmed to recognize dates where a Major Feast overlaps a standard Sunday (e.g., offering the priest an immediate choice between *All Saints' Day* or *Proper 26*).
- **Scripture Ingestion:** Pulls authorized translations (e.g., NRSV, ESV) for all four designated readings.

3. Cover Artwork Engine

- Lorenzo noted that the cover image is one of the three primary elements that changes every week.
- **Liturgical Art Library:** The agent automatically recommends royalty-free, high-resolution sacred artwork and liturgical banners matching that Sunday's color and lectionary theme (e.g., Pentecost red, Advent violet, Ordinary Time green, or All Saints gold/white).
- **Custom Artwork Upload:** Clergy can easily drag-and-drop their own custom parish photo or youth ministry graphic for the cover.

4. Music Licensing: OneLicense.net Strategy

Because OneLicense does not provide a public developer API, and scraping user credentials violates publisher Terms of Service, Phase 1 employs a legally compliant, low-friction approach:

- **Tier 1: The "Assisted Upload" Drop-Zone (Core MVP Workflow):**
    - The priest specifies the hymn titles and numbers (e.g., *"Hymn 287, 620, 293, 625"*).
    - The system formats the hymn titles, authors, and metadata in the layout, reserving auto-scaling image containers.
    - A drag-and-drop drop-zone allows the user to drop in their downloaded OneLicense score image (JPEG/PNG) in seconds.
- **Tier 2: Embedded Public Domain Hymnal Library:**
    - Pre-loaded catalog of classic, non-copyrighted hymns (e.g., historical selections from *The Hymnal 1982*). These scores insert automatically with zero upload required.
- **Tier 3: Long-Term Partner API Path:**
    - Architectural readiness to integrate direct publisher partner APIs (OneLicense / CCLI) in later iterations.

5. Smart Announcement Copywriter & Calendar Ingestion

- **LLM Polishing Engine:** Transforms fragmented bullet points (e.g., *"vestry tues 7pm, youth apple picking sat 9am"*) into warm, articulate parish notices with standardized dates, times, and locations.
- **Calendar Sync (Optional):** Capable of reading Google Calendar or parish website iCal feeds to automatically suggest upcoming parish events.

6. Dynamic Templating, Preview & Dual Mandatory Footers

- **Template Engine:** Modular formatting supporting standard bi-fold leaflets, 4-page booklets, and side-by-side **Bilingual (English/Spanish)** liturgies.
- **Interactive WYSIWYG Preview:** A split-screen browser interface allowing clergy to review page counts, make text edits, and balance margins before generating the document.
- **Dual Mandatory Compliance Footers:** The back cover automatically prints:
    1. **Music Licensing Attribution:** *"Reprinted with permission under ONE LICENSE #A-xxxxxx. All rights reserved."*
    2. **Mandatory AI Transparency Notice:** Per Lorenzo's explicit requirement, every bulletin displays:
       "AI assistance was used in the compilation and layout of this bulletin."
- **Production Output:** Generates high-resolution, 300 DPI, duplex print-ready PDFs formatted for standard church copiers.

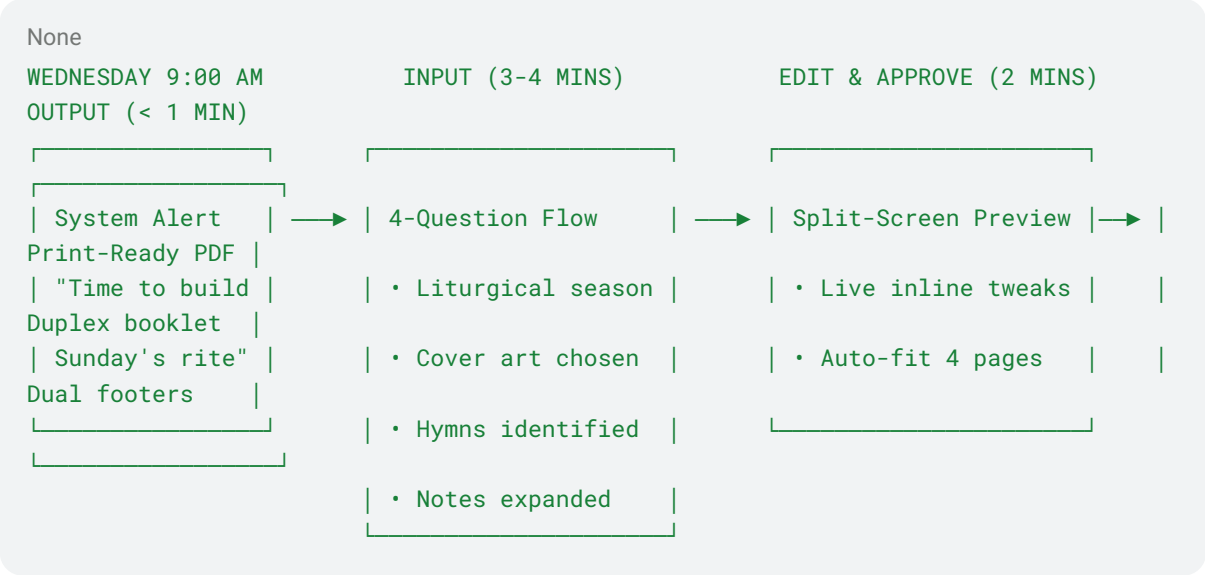
Phase 2: Multimedia & Expansion Roadmap

Phase 2 transitions the platform from a Sunday print tool into a comprehensive digital communications hub:

1. **Automated Sermon Video Repurposing (Opus Clip Model):**
    - Connects to church live streams on YouTube or Facebook Live.
    - Isolates the sermon portion from the surrounding liturgical service.
    - Uses AI speech analysis to extract compelling 30–60 second clips, applies 9:16 vertical cropping, and overlays animated captions and subtle background music.
2. **Progressive Trust Publishing ("Draft-First" Architecture):**
    - *Phase 2A (Supervised Mode):* Adopting the workflow of the Virginia priest Lorenzo referenced, video clips are initially generated as **Saved Drafts** in the parish dashboard. The priest reviews the clip and clicks "Post."
    - *Phase 2B (Autonomous Mode):* Once the priest develops complete trust in the AI's editorial selections, they can toggle on "Auto-Pilot" to allow direct posting to Instagram Reels, TikTok, and YouTube Shorts.
3. **Parish PR Suite:**
    - **Newsletter Generator:** Automatically transforms the week's approved bulletin copy into an email-ready newsletter (Mailchimp/Constant Contact).
    - **Conversational Press Release Bot:** Conducts a brief Q&A with clergy regarding special events (e.g., a community feeding program) and outputs local press releases.

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3. Phase 1 User Journey



Profile Archetype

- **User:** Father Thomas (Parish Rector)
- **Goal:** Assemble Sunday's 4-page service leaflet without formatting headaches or layout errors.

Step-by-Step Experience

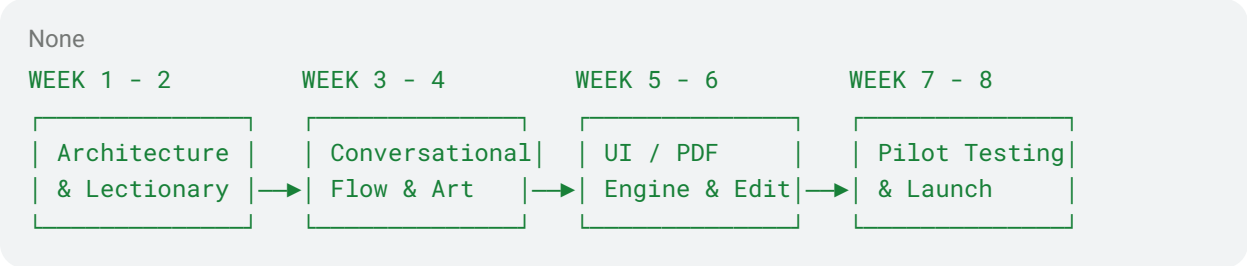
Stage	User Action	System Action
0. One-Time Setup	Inputs church name, denomination, default Bible translation (NRSV), preferred layout template, and **OneLicense #A-700000**.	Saves profile defaults, configures template geometry, and stores persistent licensing footers.
1. Liturgical Selection	Receives weekly notification. The bot asks: *"Sunday is Nov 1. Are we celebrating **All Saints' Day** or **Proper 26 (Track 1)**?"* Father Thomas selects **[All Saints' Day]**.	Queries internal RCL engine. Ingests First Reading, Psalm with Antiphon, Epistle, and Gospel for All Saints. Enforces lectionary track logic.

Stage	User Action	System Action
2. Cover Artwork	The bot prompts: *"Would you like our suggested All Saints cover art, or do you have a custom image?"* Father Thomas clicks **[Use Suggested All Saints Icon]**.	Slots the high-resolution liturgical artwork into the cover template with appropriate aspect ratio and margin scaling.
3. Hymn Ingestion	The bot asks: *"Which hymns are we singing?"* User replies: *"Opening 287, Sequence 620, Offertory 293, Closing 625."*	Inserts hymn titles and copyright citations. Auto-loads public domain sheet music; generates drag-and-drop drop-zones for licensed scores.
4. Announcements	The bot asks: *"What announcements go on the back page?"* User types raw bullet points: • *vestry meeting tuesday 7pm library* • *youth apple picking sat 9am* • *soup kitchen volunteers needed*	LLM rewrites the notes into clear, grammatically polished parish blurbs with bold titles and complete details.
5. Review & In-Line Edit	Father Thomas opens the split-screen view (Editor on Left, Live PDF Preview on Right).	Verifies that all content fits exactly within 4 pages. Corrects one minor detail directly in the interactive preview.
6. Final Production	Clicks **[Generate Print PDF]**.	Compiles a 300 DPI, duplex print-ready PDF ready for the office copier. Prints both required footers: OneLicense credit + *"AI assistance was used in the compilation and layout of this bulletin."*

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4. Implementation Timeline (Target: January / Q1 Launch)

The project follows an intensive **8-week sprint structure** designed to deliver an MVP ready for parish pilots in January.



- **Weeks 1–2 (Data Modeling & Lectionary Engine):**
  - Establish database architecture for parish accounts, templates, and lectionary data.
  - Build the complete deterministic Revised Common Lectionary (RCL) database (Years A, B, C; Propers; Track 1/2 Old Testament/Psalm mechanics).
  - Integrate Bible scripture retrieval pipelines.
- **Weeks 3–4 (Conversational Flow, Cover Art & Music Module):**
  - Build the 4-question conversational state machine.
  - Implement the Liturgical Cover Art selection library and image upload handler.
  - Implement the hymn selection system (Public Domain library + OneLicense assisted drop-zones).
  - Build the LLM announcement generation and styling prompt engine.
- **Weeks 5–6 (Templating, WYSIWYG Preview & Dual-Footer PDF Engine):**
  - Build core responsive templates (Bi-fold booklet, Single-sheet, Bilingual English/Spanish).
  - Develop the split-screen interactive preview and inline editing interface.
  - Implement the 300 DPI PDF rendering pipeline with automated dual compliance footers.
- **Weeks 7–8 (Hardening, Pilot Testing & Launch):**
  - Conduct real-world bulletin generation tests with select pilot clergy.
  - Collect user feedback on conversational pacing and layout stability.
  - Deploy production infrastructure for the January / Q1 launch.

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5. Commercial Framework & Lorenzo's Review Workflow

Per Lorenzo's instructions on pricing and proposal workflow:

1. **Scope-First Review:** This document is presented specifically to finalize the feature breakdown and ensure all critical capabilities are accurately mapped between **Phase 1** and **Phase 2**.
2. **Flexible Boundary Adjustments:** Lorenzo can review this scope and adjust items between phases (e.g., adding or deferring specific template variants or announcement features) prior to financial commitments.

3. **Commercial Quote:** Once the Phase 1 feature set is approved during next week's review meeting, Parag and the engineering team will deliver the formal commercial quote and milestones for kickoff.